

Paradiem

The Morning Brief

SEPTEMBER 28, 2026

Doomsday Rhetoric

Reported Iranian escalation and reported Trump-Araghchi standoff reverse Friday's oil pullback into a reported Monday bid.

S&P 500 (SPY, FRI CLOSE) \$771.35 ↑0.54% Fri · ES! reportedly ↓~0.29% Sun eve per Trading Strategy Guides	BRENT (LIVE MON) / WTI (LIVE MON) Reportedly ~\$107/bbl ↑~2.6% per The National / Reportedly ~\$93/bbl ↑~1% per Vantage Markets	10Y YIELD / GOLD (LIVE MON) Reportedly ~5.21% ↑5 bp per Trading Economics / GLD Fri \$393.41 · Gold reportedly ↓~3% Mon per Trading Economics	BITCOIN (LIVE MON) Reportedly ~\$83.1K · ↓~1.6% 24h per Rio Times / CoinDesk	FEAR & GREED (CNN STOCK) Reportedly in Fear zone per Benzinga · Drop reads 74 crypto fallback
--	---	---	---	--

SECTION 01

Markets — Reported Weekend Iran Escalation Reverses Friday's Oil Pullback Into a Monday Bid; Reported PCE Wednesday and Reported Payrolls Friday Anchor the Week

REPORTED SUNDAY-EVENING FUTURES REPORTEDLY SLIP ON REPORTED OIL BID; REPORTED DURATION LAYER REPORTEDLY COMPRESSES FURTHER WITH THE REPORTED 10-YEAR NEAR APPROXIMATELY 5.21%

Per Trading Strategy Guides and Vantage Markets coverage of the reported Sunday-evening tape, reported S&P 500 e-mini futures reportedly opened approximately ↓0.29% into the reported Monday setup, with reported Dow and reported Nasdaq futures also reportedly softer as reported WTI crude reportedly bid approximately +1% to near \$93/bbl and reported Brent reportedly moved approximately +2.6% to near \$107/bbl per The National coverage of the reported Iran-US impasse. Per Trading Economics coverage of the reported Treasury curve carried through the weekend, the reported 10-year yield reportedly reached approximately 5.21% (reportedly ↑5 bp) into the Monday setup, and per Reuters coverage carried in the data drop, one piece reportedly framed the dollar as holding firm as reported US-Iran tensions reportedly lifted oil and reportedly reinforced hawkish Fed bets. Per data drop, Friday's reported chip-and-connector leadership reportedly closed with CRDO ↑7.65% at \$210.97, QCOM ↑3.97% at \$201.97, NXPI ↑3.44% at \$238.08, ADI ↑2.87% at \$393.60, and LRCX ↑2.62% at \$315.21, framing a reported semiconductor-anchored Friday advance now reading against a reported Monday oil bid. Per data drop, Carson's active SPY support level at \$645.80 (retracement target set April 13) remains untouched, with Friday's reported intraday low of \$766.29 well above that level.

S&P 500 (SPY, FRI CLOSE)	\$771.35 ↑0.54% Fri · ES! reportedly ↓~0.29% Sun eve per Trading Strategy Guides
NASDAQ (QQQ) / DOW (DIA, FRI)	\$744.50 ↑0.46% / \$517.49 ↑0.94% per data drop
BRENT (LIVE MON) / WTI (LIVE MON)	Reportedly ~\$107/bbl ↑~2.6% per The National / Reportedly ~\$93/bbl ↑~1% per Vantage Markets
10Y YIELD / TLT (FRI)	Reportedly ~5.21% ↑5 bp per Trading Economics / TLT \$79.32 ↓0.13% per data drop
GOLD / COPPER (LIVE MON)	Reportedly ~\$4,157/oz ↓~3.0% per Trading Economics / Reportedly ~\$6.55/lb ↓~2.2% per Trading Economics
BITCOIN (LIVE MON) / IBIT (FRI)	Reportedly ~\$83.1K · ↓~1.6% 24h per Rio Times / IBIT \$47.57 ↓0.50% per data drop
FED OCT 27–28 HIKE ODDS	Reportedly ~66% for +25 bp per Trading Economics coverage of CME FedWatch
CARSON'S ACTIVE SPY SUPPORT	\$645.80 retracement target · Untouched (Fri low \$766.29)

REPORTED AUGUST PCE WEDNESDAY SITS AT THE CENTER OF A REPORTED DATA-HEAVY WEEK THAT ALSO REPORTEDLY INCLUDES REPORTED Q2 GDP THIRD ESTIMATE AND THE REPORTED NATIONAL ECONOMIC ACCOUNTS ANNUAL UPDATE

Per Bureau of Economic Analysis release calendar coverage carried through Stock Market Hours and Finance Calendar, the reported August Personal Income and Outlays release (including the reported PCE inflation series) is reportedly scheduled Wednesday, September 30 at 8:30 AM ET, and per BEA coverage, the reported September 30 release also reportedly includes the reported Q2 GDP third estimate alongside the reported annual update to the National Economic Accounts (which reportedly supersedes currently published estimates). Per BEA coverage of the reported July release, reported headline PCE reportedly printed +0.2% MoM and +3.7% YoY with reported core PCE at +0.2% MoM and +3.3% YoY, framing the reported August print as the reported final inflation read before the reported October 2 September Employment Situation from BLS (also reportedly scheduled at 8:30 AM ET per BLS). For FCI positioning, the

composition — a reported PCE-and-GDP data cluster Wednesday, a reported ISM Manufacturing print Thursday, a reported September payrolls print Friday, and a reported hawkish-skewed Fed path with reported October hike odds reportedly near approximately 66% per Trading Economics coverage of CME FedWatch — keeps CHD, CL, ABT, SYK, DGX, ADP, SPGI, NEE, EIX, ATO, and the reported FCI Dividend rate-sensitive-and-consumer sleeve reading through the reported household channel and the reported October 27–28 FOMC decision.

REPORTED GOLD AND REPORTED COPPER REPORTEDLY SELLING OFF SHARPLY ON REPORTED RATE-HIKE BETS; REPORTED CCL REPORTEDLY REPORTS Q3 EARNINGS TODAY

Per Trading Economics coverage of the reported Monday commodities tape, reported spot gold reportedly fell approximately ↓3.0% to near \$4,157/oz and reported copper reportedly fell approximately ↓2.2% to near \$6.55/lb into the Monday setup — a reported precious-and-industrial-metals reversal reportedly driven by a reported stronger dollar and reported rising Treasury yields as reported rate-hike expectations reportedly built through the weekend. Per Reuters coverage carried in the data drop, one piece reportedly framed gold as dropping more than 2% on reported US rate-hike bets, and per data drop, Friday's reported GLD close at \$393.41 (↑0.44%) reportedly precedes the reported Monday reversal. Per data drop earnings section, Carnival Corp (CCL) reportedly reports Q3 earnings today with reported consensus of approximately \$1.37 EPS — a reported first material corporate print into the reported PCE-and-payrolls week. For FCI positioning, the composition — a reported metals reversal reportedly reading through the reported hawkish Fed path, a reported oil bid reportedly reading through the reported Iran-US impasse, and a reported hydrocarbon-vs-metals divergence into the Monday open — keeps FCX, AEM, CVX, OKE, and the reported FCI Growth-Hybrid commodities sleeve reading through the reported cross-asset positioning.

A reported Sunday-evening reversal in the reported oil tape from Friday's pullback into a reported Monday bid, sitting against a reported precious-and-industrial-metals selloff on reported hawkish Fed bets and a reported 10-year yield reportedly reaching approximately 5.21%, frames a Monday setup that tends to reward reading each cross-current on its own terms rather than compositing a single directional view. Simplicity over complexity.

SECTION 02

Geopolitics — Araghchi Reportedly Warns of “Doomsday War” on NBC News as Trump Reportedly Signals Post-Midterm Bombing Resumption per WSJ; Reported Saudi FM Reportedly Arrives in Washington for Rubio Talks

REPORTED IRANIAN FOREIGN MINISTER REPORTEDLY ESCALATES RHETORIC IN REPORTED NBC NEWS INTERVIEW; REPORTED WALL STREET JOURNAL REPORTEDLY FRAMES TRUMP AS PLANNING TO RESUME STRIKES AFTER THE REPORTED NOVEMBER MIDTERMS

Per Business Today, The Tribune, Khaama Press, and News Bytes coverage of the reported Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi's reported NBC News interview Sunday, Araghchi reportedly stated that Iran is reportedly “fully prepared” for a reported “doomsday war” with the United States if reported military aggression reportedly resumes, reportedly adding that Iran reportedly does not care about the reported US midterm elections and reportedly cares about its reported national interests. Per the same coverage, Araghchi reportedly addressed a reported Wall Street Journal report which reportedly stated that President Trump had reportedly told aides he expected to resume bombing Iran after the reported November midterms, and per NBC News, Araghchi reportedly framed the choice as up to President Trump between diplomacy and war. Per The National coverage of the reported Monday oil tape, reported Brent crude reportedly rose approximately +2.6% to near \$107/bbl and reported WTI reportedly rose approximately +1% to near \$93/bbl as reported US-Iran peace talks reportedly stalled. Per data drop headlines, one Reuters piece reportedly framed the reported Saudi foreign minister as reportedly arriving in Washington for reported talks with Secretary of State Marco Rubio, and per separate Reuters coverage carried in the drop, one piece reportedly framed cash-rich oil majors as reportedly facing a reported post-Iran strategy rethink. For FCI positioning, the composition — a reported Iranian escalation of rhetoric, a reported WSJ-framed post-midterm bombing signal, a reported Saudi FM visit reportedly framing a reported broader regional-security consultation, and a reported Monday oil bid reportedly reversing Friday's pullback — keeps CVX, OKE, CNX, LMT, GD, and the reported FCI energy-and-defense sleeve reading through the reported physical-crude signal, the reported sanctions perimeter, and the reported diplomatic gap into the Monday open.

REPORTED UK FAIRFORD AIR BASE INVESTIGATION REPORTEDLY WIDENS AS REPORTED FIVE MEN ARE REPORTEDLY QUESTIONED; REPORTED GERMAN GAS SUPPLY REPORTEDLY FRAMED AS SECURE DESPITE REPORTED LOW STORAGE LEVELS

Per Reuters coverage carried in the data drop headlines, one piece reportedly framed reported UK police as reportedly questioning reported five men held at the reported airbase used by the US to reportedly attack Iran, and per separate Reuters coverage carried in the drop, one piece reportedly framed reported German gas supply as reportedly secure despite reported low storage levels per the reported VNG chief. Per additional Reuters coverage carried in the drop, one

piece reportedly framed reported Indian shares as reportedly hitting a reported near six-month low as the reported US-Iran deadlock reportedly lifted oil prices, and per additional Reuters coverage, one piece reportedly framed reported stocks as reportedly slipping in Asia as reported oil and yields reportedly climbed. Per data drop, LMT reportedly closed Friday approximately ↓0.79% at \$519.56 and GD reportedly closed near-flat at \$336.72 into the reported still-live regional-attack backdrop, and per data drop holdings news, one piece reportedly framed Lockheed Martin as reportedly receiving another boost from the reported long-range missile push. For FCI positioning, the composition — a reported UK airbase

investigation reportedly widening, a reported European gas-security read reportedly holding, a reported Asian equity spillover from the reported oil bid, and a reported defense-narrative continuing behind the reported diplomatic gap —

keeps LMT, GD, CVX, OKE, CNX, and NEE reading through the reported physical-crude signal, the reported regional-attack layer, and the reported cross-asset spillover into the Monday setup.

On Our Radar

1. Week Ahead — Reported August PCE Wednesday, September 30 at 8:30 AM ET (Reported With Q2 GDP Third Estimate); Reported ISM Manufacturing Thursday October 1 at 10:00 AM ET; Reported September Nonfarm Payrolls Friday October 2 at 8:30 AM ET; Reported CCL Reportedly Reports Today.

Per Bureau of Economic Analysis release calendar coverage, the reported August Personal Income and Outlays release (including the reported PCE inflation series) is reportedly scheduled Wednesday, September 30 at 8:30 AM ET alongside the reported Q2 GDP third estimate. Per BLS release calendar coverage, the reported September Employment Situation is reportedly scheduled Friday, October 2 at 8:30 AM ET, and per ISM release calendar coverage, the reported September ISM Manufacturing PMI is reportedly scheduled Thursday, October 1 at 10:00 AM ET. Per data drop earnings section, Carnival (CCL) reportedly reports Q3 earnings today with reported consensus of approximately \$1.37 EPS. For FCI positioning, the composition keeps CAT, PCAR, FAST, GD, LMT, and the reported FCI Dividend industrial sleeve reading through the reported factory print while the reported rate-sensitive sleeve reads through the reported PCE-and-payrolls signal.

2. Reported Iran-US Escalation — Araghchi Reportedly Warns of “Doomsday War” on Reported NBC News; WSJ Reportedly Frames Trump as Planning Post-Midterm Bombing Resumption; Reported Brent Reportedly ↑~2.6% Monday to Near \$107.

Per Business Today, The Tribune, Khaama Press, and NBC News coverage of the reported Sunday interview, Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi reportedly stated Iran is reportedly “fully prepared” for a reported “doomsday war” with the United States and reportedly framed the choice between war and diplomacy as up to President Trump. Per The National coverage of the reported Monday oil tape, reported Brent crude reportedly rose approximately +2.6% to near \$107/bbl and reported WTI reportedly rose approximately +1% to near \$93/bbl as reported US-Iran peace talks reportedly stalled. Per data drop headlines, one Reuters piece reportedly framed the reported Saudi foreign minister as reportedly arriving in Washington for reported talks with Secretary of State Marco Rubio. For FCI positioning — a reported Iranian rhetoric escalation, a reported WSJ-framed post-midterm bombing signal, a reported Monday oil bid reversing Friday’s pullback, and a reported Saudi FM Washington visit — keeps CVX, OKE, CNX, LMT, and GD reading through the reported physical-crude signal into the Monday open.

3. Reported Nvidia RTX PRO 5500 Reportedly Green-Lit for Reported Alibaba and Reported ByteDance per Yahoo/Data Drop; Reported TSMC 2nm Wafer Capacity Reportedly Reads Above Earlier Estimates per EDN.

Per data drop holdings news, one Yahoo Finance piece reportedly framed reported Nvidia chips for reported Alibaba and reported ByteDance as reportedly getting a reported China green light on the reported RTX PRO 5500 amid reported US curbs, and per separate data drop holdings news, one Yahoo Finance piece reportedly framed reported TSMC 2nm wafer capacity as reportedly exceeding reported earlier estimates per reported EDN reporting (a reported read-through for QCOM, AMD, and TSM per data drop coverage). Per data drop holdings news, one Yahoo Finance piece reportedly framed reported VSMC (a reported TSMC-Vanguard-NXPI joint venture) as reportedly celebrating the reported grand opening of its reported first 300mm fab in Singapore. For FCI positioning, the composition — a reported China-Nvidia workaround reportedly reading through the reported Alibaba-and-ByteDance channel, a reported 2nm capacity beat framing a reported Pacific-technology supply-chain read, and a reported Singapore fab opening framing a reported geographic-diversification thread — keeps NVDA, AMD, TSM, MRVL, LRCX, KEYS, CRDO, TEL, ADI, NXPI, and QCOM reading through the reported semiconductor supply-chain layer into the Monday setup.

4. Reported Metals Reversal — Gold Reportedly ↓~3.0% Monday to Near \$4,157/oz per Trading Economics; Copper Reportedly ↓~2.2% to Near \$6.55/lb; Reported Rate-Hike Bets Reportedly Reinforce a Stronger Dollar.

Per Trading Economics coverage of the reported Monday commodities tape, reported spot gold reportedly fell approximately ↓3.0% to near \$4,157/oz and reported copper reportedly fell approximately ↓2.2% to near \$6.55/lb, and per Reuters coverage carried in the data drop, one piece reportedly framed gold as dropping more than 2% on reported US rate-hike bets. Per data drop, Friday’s reported GLD close at \$393.41 (↓0.44%) and reported SLV close at \$58.14 (↓0.90%) reportedly precede the reported Monday reversal, and reported FCX closed Friday at \$72.31 (↑0.32%) into the reported industrial-metals context. For FCI positioning — a reported metals reversal reportedly reading through the reported hawkish Fed path and a reported stronger dollar — keeps FCX, AEM, and the reported FCI commodities sleeve reading through the reported cross-asset positioning into the Monday setup.

5. Reported Bitcoin Reportedly Slips to Near \$83.1K After Reported Sunday High of Approximately \$85K; Reported US Spot Bitcoin ETFs Reportedly Recorded Approximately \$2.4 Billion in Reported Weekly Net Inflows per KuCoin. Per Rio Times and CoinDesk coverage of the reported Monday tape, Bitcoin (BTC) reportedly slipped to near \$83,100 after reportedly touching approximately \$85,160 on reported Coinbase Sunday, reportedly ↓~1.6% over the reported 24 hours. Per KuCoin and Rio Times coverage of the reported drivers, the reported weekend selloff was reportedly driven by reported Iran-related geopolitical concerns. Per data drop holdings news, one Yahoo Finance piece reportedly framed Bitcoin as holding near \$84,000 as reported rising bond yields reportedly offset reported regulatory progress. Per KuCoin coverage of the reported US spot Bitcoin ETF flow tape, reported US spot Bitcoin ETFs reportedly recorded approximately \$134 million in reported net inflows on reported September 25 and reported weekly inflows reportedly totaled approximately \$2.4 billion per the same coverage. For FCI positioning — a reported BTC slip on reported Iran-linked risk-off reportedly offset by a reported strong US-spot-ETF inflow trend — keeps IBIT and ETHA reading through the reported crypto signal into the Monday setup.

For internal FCI investment committee use only. Not investment advice. Information from public sources believed reliable. Past performance not indicative of future results. FCI is an RIA under Paradiem.